

Chapter 177-5

Xu Qingzhu nodded. "Yes, cause and effect, the cycle of karma—sometimes you have no choice but to believe in fate."

Liang Shi chuckled softly. "That's true."

The two sighed with emotion for quite a while longer, then Liang Shi pulled out a book from the drawer and read a story to Xu Qingzhu.

"The stars we see with our naked eyes may have exploded and died billions of years ago. At this moment, their light reaching my pupils is the most mysterious coincidence..."

"Baby." Xu Qingzhu suddenly interrupted her. Her eyes were gently closed, her voice cool yet her tone gentle. "Do you think there's anything else on the Little Prince's planet besides the rose and the fox?"

"There should be a castle and a king too." Liang Shi said.

Xu Qingzhu paused briefly. "Is the Little Prince's planet farther from us, or is your planet farther from us?"

Liang Shi said, "I don't know."

"Are there people on all the stars we can see with our naked eyes?" Xu Qingzhu asked. "Like on the planet where you came from."

Liang Shi still shook her head. "I don't know, but there should be dimensional worlds that exist."

"What do you mean?" Xu Qingzhu said. "You mean time is progressing simultaneously in many places, and in another place there are people like us who also have their own lives, is that it?"

"More or less." Liang Shi said. "Just like on my planet and here."

"Are we humans being controlled?" Xu Qingzhu asked. "Like you and that person, being switched around at will."

"No, we're being controlled, but also not being controlled. They manipulate us according to our wishes."

"..."

Before falling asleep, the two were both thinking about strange, vast questions, and even their dreams were of endless galaxies and the universe.

The next day when they woke up, Liang Shi said she dreamed of a spaceship, and Xu Qingzhu said she dreamed of planting roses on a barren planet.

Both exclaimed how absurd their dreams were.

Once they talked it out, things actually felt better.

Having someone to listen to her boredom and worries meant Liang Shi wouldn't keep everything bottled up inside.

Many things don't seem like such a big deal once you say them out loud.

So Liang Shi didn't feel sad about the original host for too long. She only hoped that the original host could have a brand new life after going through all these things.

Time flew by, and soon it was late spring.

Yu Wan's baby had already had their one-month celebration banquet¹, and Zhao Xuning and Shen Hui had finally reconciled completely.

Zhao Xuning still hadn't told Shen Hui about the Wu Li matter.

She only said she had regretted it that day, so she went to confess.

Shen Hui didn't ask further.

When Liang Shi went to visit Yu Wan, she happened to learn that Qiu Zimin had fallen ill and was hospitalized—apparently it was quite serious.

Liang Shi didn't think about going to visit her.

Guo Xinran was still active on screen and had even taken on a TV drama, starting off with an S+ production right away.

Liang Shi wasn't envious of her; she just felt the power of capital was too strong.

When she complained to Xu Qingzhu about it, Xu Qingzhu laughed and teased her: "What? Do you also want me to help you?"

Liang Shi pinched her waist. "What kind of person do you think I am?"

"My person." Xu Qingzhu said matter-of-factly. "I want to give to you, so I give to you. I'm willing."

"I'm not willing." Liang Shi said. "I want to stick to you."

Xu Qingzhu: "?"

It was also because Xu Qingzhu's belly was getting bigger and bigger. When she was in the early months it wasn't obvious, but now that she was further along, the twin pregnancy was very apparent—Xu Qingzhu's belly was huge.

Now every day Liang Shi had to help apply cream to Xu Qingzhu's belly to prevent loose skin after giving birth.

Liang Shi felt heartache just looking at it and kept saying why couldn't they just adopt two? Why did she have to give birth herself?

Of course, her words didn't make any difference.

In everyone's view, Omegas getting pregnant and giving birth was normal.

Especially since the birth rate on this planet was so low that abortion was no longer allowed.

Since Xu Qingzhu found it inconvenient to travel now, Liang Shi drove her everywhere every day.

She didn't spend much time on set, so she found something else to do—she started filming Vlogs.

Her Vlogs weren't about herself but were themed.

Each episode was very short, like a mini documentary about a profession.

Her first episode featured the security guards of their residential complex and the neighboring complex.

All these Vlogs were filmed in her spare time. She started learning camera work, photography, editing, and even lighting on her own.

After filming three episodes, Gu Yixue took the initiative to message her: 【Like.jpg】

But Liang Shi didn't hold back: 【Where's your new script?】

Gu Yixue: 【...No ideas. Planning to adapt an IP²】

Liang Shi: 【?】

Liang Shi: 【A movie?】

Gu Yixue: 【TV drama. Should be a 12-episode short series. There's a web novel that was really popular a while ago called "Sharp Edge"—have you read it?】

Liang Shi: 【No, I haven't even heard of it.】

Gu Yixue: 【The platform is inviting me to film this now. They're offering quite a bit of money.】

Liang Shi: 【Since when do you care about money?】

Gu Yixue: 【...The novel is pretty good.】

Liang Shi felt this was her honest opinion.

For someone like Gu Yixue, money was secondary—content was what mattered most.

But Gu Yixue still had concerns. Collaborating with a platform was different from before. Having a platform meant having investors. When Gu Yixue filmed works before, it was her one-woman show. Even if investors wanted to insert someone, they had to see if Gu Yixue agreed.

If Gu Yixue said no, the investors wouldn't dare push it.

If they really made Gu Yixue angry, then the investors could take their money and get lost—Gu Yixue wasn't short on money.

If she signed with the platform, it would mean Gu Yixue couldn't do as she pleased.

Yet the novel's copyright was with the platform, and the platform had promised Gu Yixue absolute authority.

They even gave her the rights to adapt the script.

This made Gu Yixue somewhat tempted.

Liang Shi suggested she take it. She could try collaborating with others. Before, when she was alone abroad, having her own team was enough. Now that she was back in the country, she would inevitably face restrictions everywhere—she might as well lean on a big tree for shade³.

But Gu Yixue told her to read it first. If there was an opportunity, they could collaborate on another project. She thought there was a role in it that would suit Liang Shi well.

Liang Shi: "..."

Was this the benefit of having powerful friends?

Still, Liang Shi did order the book online.

She noticed the author's pen name was "Wenchuan."

She felt like she'd seen this name somewhere before.

Footnotes:

¹ One-month celebration banquet (滿月酒) - A traditional Chinese celebration held when a baby turns one month old. It's an important milestone as infant mortality was historically high in the first month, so surviving meant the baby was strong enough to celebrate. Family and friends gather for a feast to celebrate the baby's health.

² IP - Stands for "Intellectual Property." In the Chinese entertainment industry, "IP adaptation" refers to adapting existing intellectual properties like popular novels, comics, or games into TV dramas or films.

³ "Lean on a big tree for shade" (背靠大樹好乘涼) - A Chinese proverb meaning it's beneficial to have powerful backing or support. Just as standing under a big tree provides shade from the sun, having a powerful ally or organization behind you makes things easier.